Final Year Project System

Remote supervision of final year projects at UNILAK

Milestone 1

Problem discovery and user research

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The supervision problem

The project idea came from concern about travel and difficulty coordinating corrections.

Student task	Submit a chapter, receive corrections, then send the revised version.
Supervisor task	Review the latest chapter and check progress on the software project.
Distance	When feedback requires meeting in person, arranging a visit can delay the next revision.
Discovery question	Where do travel, repeated follow-ups or version confusion occur in the current process?

Who is involved

Stakeholder map grouped by relationship to supervision.

Direct users

Final-year student

Assigned supervisor

Coordinate and support

Final year project coordinator

Department administrator

Set constraints

Academic leadership

Campus ICT support

Discovery priority / Students who recently submitted a chapter and supervisors who reviewed one.

One chapter, one round of corrections

Illustrative current journey. The team will verify the channels and handoffs in interviews.

Prepare draft → Send or deliver → Receive comments → Revise and resend

Parallel task / The student updates the software repository and shares a GitHub link for review.

How the team will collect evidence

Three incident-based conversations with people who have used the supervision process.

Participants	Two final-year students and one supervisor. Recruit people with a recent submission or review.
Screening	Role, recent supervision activity and willingness to participate.
Consent	Participation is voluntary. Ask permission to take anonymised notes.
Interview record	Capture what happened, which channel was used, time spent and what happened next.
Privacy	Use participant codes. Keep names, thesis files and private repository links out of shared notes.

Interview scenario A | Chapter submission

Illustrative interview dialogue / Answers written for scenario analysis

QUESTION	ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER
Tell me how you used to submit a chapter of your thesis.	I sent Chapter One and later arranged a visit to go over the corrections.
Why did you arrange a visit?	I could see the marked sections, but I needed an explanation before rewriting them.
Tell me more about how you sent the revision.	I sent another file. We had to check the filename to see which copy was the latest.
How did you know the review was complete?	I checked again with the supervisor because I was unsure which comments still needed a reply.

Interview scenario B | Software progress

Illustrative interview dialogue / Answers written for scenario analysis

QUESTION	ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER
How did you share your last project update?	I committed the changes and sent the GitHub repository link.
What happened when your supervisor opened it?	They asked which change I wanted them to review.
Why was the link alone difficult to review?	It showed the whole repository. I had not pointed to the commit with the new work.
Tell me more about your next update.	I sent the exact commit link and explained what I had changed.

Interview scenario C | Supervisor review

Illustrative interview dialogue / Answers written for scenario analysis

QUESTION	ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER
Think of the last chapter you reviewed. How did you find it?	I searched my messages for the latest file from the student.
How did you return your corrections?	I sent the marked copy and discussed the changes that needed more explanation.
Why was it hard to check whether changes were made?	I had to open the old feedback and the revised file separately.
Tell me more about how you checked the software work.	I opened the shared GitHub link and asked the student to identify the update.

Five possible pain points

Affinity map linking sample notes to concerns for field validation.

Travel and timing	A / A follow-up visit had to be arranged before the revision.
Version confusion	A + C / Both parties had to identify the latest copy.
Feedback tracking	A + C / Outstanding comments were hard to check across messages and files.
Unclear review status	A / The student had to ask whether the review was finished.
Code update context	B + C / A repository link alone did not identify the change to review.

Two provisional user profiles

These role profiles come from the scenarios and will be refined through fieldwork.

Final-year student

Goal
Know what to correct and show the next version.

Main difficulty
Finding the latest comments and confirming whether the revision was reviewed.

Assigned supervisor

Goal
Review the correct version and see the work completed since the last update.

Main difficulty
Matching a new file or GitHub link to earlier feedback.

What existing tools cover

Three tools offer different parts of the supervision workflow.

Google Docs	Suggestions and document version history support iterative writing.
Moodle Assignment	Assignment submissions and feedback provide a model for handing in and reviewing files.
GitHub	Pull request reviews support comments and requests for changes to code.
Opportunity to test	Would a single project record help users connect chapter versions, corrections and code updates?

Working problem statement

The team will verify frequency, consequences and current practices with actual participants.

Final-year students and supervisors at UNILAK may have difficulty coordinating chapter reviews and software progress when submissions, corrections and GitHub updates are shared separately.

This can require extra follow-ups or visits and make it harder to tell what has been reviewed and what still needs work.

A focused first version

Proposed scope for the requirements milestone.

Submit

Upload a chapter under the correct project. Keep the original file and label each revision.

Review

The assigned supervisor leaves corrections against the submitted version and marks its review status.

Track

Students see pending feedback and share a GitHub commit or pull request link with a short summary.

Pilot boundary / One department, assigned student–supervisor pairs, chapter reviews and project updates.

Sources and evidence status

The course guide informs the method. The product documentation supports the tool comparison.

Course materials	Student Project Guide §5 and SECD Session Introductions, slides 16–26.
Google Docs Editors Help	Suggest edits in Google Docs. Find what changed in a file.
MoodleDocs	Assignment activity.
GitHub Docs	Giving reviews.
Field evidence	The three dialogues are illustrative. Actual interview evidence is pending.